

Matija Štepanić

Senior Software Engineer · Full-Stack & AI-Native Development

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GitHub · LinkedIn · Toptal · DOMOVINA.ai

Software engineer with 20 years of professional experience (since 2006) and 200+ delivered projects. MSc in Computer Science (FER, University of Zagreb). Founder & CEO of ITalk Ltd., Toptal Verified Expert, certified FlutterFlow Expert since 2022 with 50+ FlutterFlow consulting projects. Currently building AI-native products end-to-end: the DOMOVINA media-AI platform (RAG in ClickHouse, a public MCP server, Flutter, self-hosted Supabase) and PINKA on-chain crowdfunding. 34,000+ GitHub contributions in the last year across 109 public repositories, working open-source-first with agentic AI tooling — 16B+ tokens processed with Claude Code, fully documented in a sourced public usage record.

34,560

GitHub contributions (last 12 months)

109

public repositories

16.32B

tokens processed with Claude Code since 2025

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Lead Engineer — DOMOVINA.tv / DOMOVINA.ai

06/2025 – present

AI-native Croatian media platform: podcast/video archive with search, RAG and structured datasets, apps for web, mobile and TV.

- Designed and built the full platform solo using agentic AI development: Flutter app (web, iOS, Android, TV), self-hosted Supabase backend behind Kong on Coolify, and a Cloudflare edge layer — 29,000+ GitHub contributions across the ecosystem in one year.
- Built a 12-step media-ingestion pipeline (fetch.domovina.tv) that has processed 3,034 Croatian podcast episodes across 46 channels — ~2,870 hours of audio, 2,573 distinct speakers — into 137,451 semantic RAG chunks: Whisper.cpp on Metal and NVIDIA Canary on Colab GPUs for ASR, pyannote diarization, Gemini summarisation via multi-region Vertex AI rotation.
- Implemented RAG search over the archive — bge-m3 embeddings in ClickHouse (HNSW, ~10–50 ms) with PostgreSQL metadata — and a production MCP server (mcp.domovina.ai) with OAuth, per-client rate limiting and an audit dashboard, usable from Claude, ChatGPT and Cursor.
- Built pay.domovina.ai — SEPA EPC QR, Croatian HUB3 PDF417 and EIP-681 barcodes from a single form, with Safe 2/3 multisig routing of Monerium EURE on Gnosis Chain — plus a self-hosted SMS gateway, a catalogue of 901 Croatian football clubs and an interactive map of Croatia.

Co-Founder & Lead Engineer — PINKA Finance

09/2025 – present

On-chain crowdfunding platform — bilingual landing and campaign app on Cloudflare (Workers, D1), Next.js 14, Safe smart accounts.

- Architected and shipped the bilingual (HR/EN) marketing site and campaign/checkout app: Next.js 14 static export served by Cloudflare Workers with D1, custom i18n engine with CLDR plural rules.
- Designed a Foundry smart-contract suite (factory + ERC20Permit token + crowdfund) on Gnosis Chain with four parallel investment paths — ERC677 transferAndCall, approve+invest, SEPA via Monerium webhook, Safe multisig — and shipped the app as a Safe App that also runs framed inside Safe{Wallet}.
- Independently verified a public on-chain fan-token lottery (modric-lottery-verify) with reproducible scripts over chain data.

Founder, CEO & Senior Software Engineer — ITalk Ltd.

01/2016 – present

Boutique software consultancy. Toptal Verified Expert (since 2022), certified FlutterFlow Expert (since May 2022), 50+ FlutterFlow consulting projects, full-stack delivery for international clients.

- Worked as a FlutterFlow expert/consultant on 50+ projects: custom Flutter features, Firebase Cloud Functions integrations, published reusable open-source FlutterFlow components.
- Built a FlutterFlow identity-document scanning widget on top of BlinkID native SDKs, adopted by 1,119 different FlutterFlow projects.
- Developed FirePixy — photo-booth & event photo crowdsourcing platform: Node.js serverless backend (Firebase), Angular PWA, WPF photo-booth app integrated with the Canon EOS SDK.
- Led a team of 9 building ScanShop, a self-checkout retail platform: architecture and backend with NestJS + Parse Server, Angular PWA, native iOS/Android apps.
- Consulted for Microblink: server-side OCR bridge with API-key management for their SaaS, and a JavaScript web component + desktop-to-mobile handoff flow for document scanning.
- Built the backend for Tempo, an EU-funds project progress-tracking application (NestJS, Parse Server, Firebase), and a static-site platform (Angular + Scully + Flamelink CMS) powering multiple production sites since 2020.

Ten years of freelance full-stack work: 100+ commercial websites and internal tools, long-lived production systems.

- Developed an internal CRM for membership and activities of a Croatian public organisation — in production since 2008 with ~1,500 active users.
- Built a custom CMS and website for a Croatian business news agency; co-founded and built the backend of Mobicon, a crowd-microphone application.
- Delivered 100+ commercial websites and internal tools (PHP, Java, Node.js, MySQL/PostgreSQL/MongoDB, AWS, Spring Boot, Yii).

SELECTED PROJECTS

DOMOVINA.tv / DOMOVINA.ai — Founder & sole engineer 2025 – present
AI-native Croatian media platform of 30+ public repositories, built end-to-end by one engineer. An automated pipeline (Whisper.cpp on Metal, NVIDIA Canary on Colab GPUs, pyannote diarization, Gemini via multi-region Vertex AI) has processed 3,034 podcast episodes across 46 channels into 137,451 semantic RAG chunks, searchable through a public MCP server and a Flutter app that ships to web (WASM), iOS, Android and Android TV. domovina.ai · github.com/domovinatv · mcp.domovina.ai/health · pay.domovina.ai · klubovi.domovina.ai
Flutter · Dart · Python · Node.js · TypeScript · Supabase · PostgreSQL · ClickHouse · Whisper · Gemini · Cloudflare Workers · D1 · Coolify · RAG · MCP · Safe

domovina-rag — RAG backend & public MCP server — Author 2026 – present
Self-hosted semantic-search backend over a Croatian podcast corpus: 137,451 RAG chunks from 3,034 episodes across 46 channels (~2,870 hours of audio, 2,573 distinct speakers), embedded with bge-m3 and stored in ClickHouse (HNSW vector index, ~10–50 ms queries) alongside PostgreSQL as the transactional source of truth. Exposed worldwide through a production MCP server, so Claude Desktop, Claude.ai, ChatGPT and Cursor can query the corpus as a native tool. github.com/domovinatv/domovina-rag · mcp.domovina.ai/health · stats.domovina.ai
TypeScript · Python · ClickHouse · PostgreSQL · bge-m3 · MCP · Cloudflare R2 · Coolify · Docker

PINKA Finance — Co-founder & lead engineer 2025 – present
Group-fundraising platform bridging bank transfers and on-chain money. Campaign & checkout app (Next.js 14) where backers pay by scanning a SEPA EPC QR code or on-chain via Monerium EURE on Gnosis Chain; Foundry smart-contract suite (PinkaFactory, PinkaToken, PinkaCrowdfund) supports four parallel investment paths — ERC677 transferAndCall, approve+invest, SEPA bank transfer via Monerium webhook, and Safe multisig. pinka.finance · github.com/pinka-finance · github.com/pinka-finance/pinka-app
Next.js 14 · TypeScript · Solidity · Foundry · Safe · Gnosis Chain · Monerium EURE · Supabase · Cloudflare · Tailwind

flutter_certilia — Author & maintainer 2025 – present
Open-source Flutter package for the Certilia Identity API — Croatian national eID (NIAS) authentication for Flutter apps, with documentation site. 110+ commits in the last year. github.com/stepanic/flutter_certilia · github.com/stepanic/flutter-certilia-docs
Flutter · Dart · OAuth2 · eID

FirePixy — Creator 2017 – present
Complete platform for photo booths and photo walls at weddings and community events: serverless Node.js backend on Firebase, Angular PWA for guests, WPF photo-booth application integrated with Canon EOS DSLR cameras and on-site printing, Flutter mobile apps. Node.js · Firebase · Angular · WPF · Canon EDSDK · Flutter

ScanShop — Architect & backend lead (team of 9) 2018 – 2021
Self-checkout native mobile application for retail stores. Defined the architecture and built the backend (NestJS + Parse Server + Firebase) while leading a team of nine across backend, Angular PWA and native iOS/Android apps. Contributed improvements back to the open-source Parse Dashboard project. NestJS · Parse Server · Firebase · Angular · Swift · Kotlin

FlutterFlow BlinkID Widget — Author 2022 – 2024
Custom FlutterFlow widget wrapping native iOS/Android identity-document scanning SDKs (BlinkID). Reads identity documents with the device camera and returns structured data into FlutterFlow action chains. Adopted by 1,119 different FlutterFlow projects. FlutterFlow · Flutter · BlinkID · iOS · Android

SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript / JavaScript (15 yrs) · Dart (7 yrs) · SQL (18 yrs) · Bash (15 yrs) · PHP (18 yrs) · Python (6 yrs) · Solidity (3 yrs) · Java (10 yrs) · Kotlin (4 yrs) · Swift (4 yrs) · HTML / CSS / SCSS (20 yrs)

Frameworks & Runtimes: Node.js (15 yrs) · Flutter (7 yrs) · FlutterFlow (5 yrs) · Next.js / React (5 yrs) · NestJS (8 yrs) · Angular (10 yrs) · Parse Server (8 yrs)

Cloud & Infrastructure: Cloudflare (Workers, D1, R2, Pages) (3 yrs) · Firebase / GCP (12 yrs) · Supabase (self-hosted) (2 yrs) · Docker / Coolify (9 yrs) · AWS (8 yrs) · CI/CD (GitHub Actions) (8 yrs) · PostgreSQL / MySQL / MongoDB (15 yrs)

AI Engineering: Agentic development (Claude Code) (2 yrs) · RAG pipelines (2 yrs) · MCP servers (2 yrs) · LLM APIs (Anthropic, OpenAI) (3 yrs)

Web3 / Blockchain: EVM / Solidity (3 yrs) · Safe smart accounts (2 yrs) · On-chain verification (2 yrs)

Other: Software architecture (14 yrs) · Team leadership (8 yrs) · OCR / identity documents (BlinkID) (7 yrs) · Payments (Stripe, stablecoins, SMS) (6 yrs)

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Computer Science — University of Zagreb, Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computing (FER) 2013 – 2015

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science — University of Zagreb, Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computing (FER) 2009 – 2013

Certifications: Toptal Verified Expert in Engineering (Toptal, 2022) · Certified FlutterFlow Expert (FlutterFlow, 2022)

Languages: Croatian — Native · English — Full professional proficiency